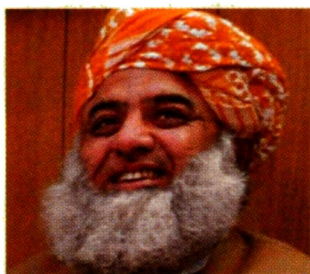


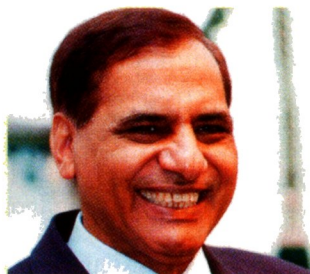
FAZLUR RAHMAN

Among the mullahs, the JUI leader stands to lose the most in a face-off between Musharraf and religious forces. Controls the NWFP Government and a part of the ruling coalition in Balochistan. Willing to deal with anyone but does not want to be seen as having sold out the religious cause.



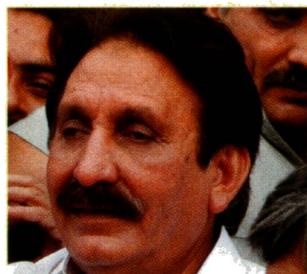
GENERAL EHSAN UL HAQ

The joint chief of army staff committee backs Musharraf for now but may step in if the situation becomes dire and Musharraf begins to be considered a liability. Already feeling the heat for fighting what many in Pakistan and within the army consider US's war on Pakistan's own people.



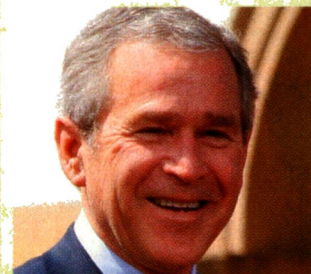
IFTIKHAR CHAUDHRY

Enjoying public adulation since his restoration as the chief justice. Seems unhesitant to invoke suo moto powers. Has already set alarm bells ringing with judgements on disappeared persons and Sharif's right to return. May give adverse ruling about Musharraf's ability to be re-elected president.



GEORGE BUSH

The US President wants to forge a secular, liberal alliance against religious forces to bolster America's war against Al Qaeda in Pakistan and Afghanistan. Has been pushing hard for a deal between Musharraf and Bhutto. But may be oblivious of the long-term consequences of such polarisation.



General may attempt in his bid to hold on to power. But perhaps none is as dangerous or unpredictable for him as his own ego.

There is widespread consensus in Pakistan that had he not made the mistake of alienating the chief justice—and with him almost the entire superior judiciary—Musharraf may have sailed through with his re-election. Certainly, the political opposition was nowhere near as potent then as it now seems. "The problem is that I am not sure Musharraf recognises that the world has changed," says a senior journalist who has attended various confidential briefings at the Presidency. "He seems still to be negotiating to retain the maximum amount of power but should be looking at things as a matter of survival. It's just not the same Pakistan it was even earlier this year."

Other analysts are even more blunt. "Two choices stand before him," writes political commentator Ayaz Amir in *Dawn* about Musharraf's prospects. "He can resist change and in the process emulate the undignified exits of (generals) Ayub Khan and Yahya Khan. Or he can become the bridge from this order to the next and still write some kind of an honourable name for himself in this country's troubled history."

Since Musharraf is unlikely to simply step down, as Amir advocates, what are the options in front of him? His first order of priority is to get himself re-elected as President. His term of office expires in November and, legally, the presidential elections must take place between September 15 and October 15. However, not only is there stiff opposition to him standing for re-election as a uniformed President—the present

Parliament had allowed him to continue to hold the position of army chief till the end of his current term—he also faces constitutional hurdles even if he were to step down from the army. Under current law pertaining to government employees—which he is one of as army chief—he may not be able to stand for election for two years of leaving government service. As such, he would require a constitutional amendment or risk the Supreme Court striking down his candidacy.

There is also the moral issue, raised by many critics, of Musharraf being re-elected from a parliament at the end of its own term, a peculiar situation that has arisen because Musharraf assumed the office of President through a referendum—later ratified—before the current parliament came into being. He now faces a presidential poll the way it



Did you know DuPont helps harness the sun to provide electricity?

Innovations for Sustainability

DuPont is a leading material and technology supplier to the photovoltaic (PV) industry. Offering the broadest portfolio in the photovoltaic solar market with eight key materials used to make solar cells and modules. DuPont is focusing on India for this sustainable solution as its geographical position ensures that India receives solar energy equivalent to nearly 5,000 trillion kWh/year. Enabling DuPont to provide a better, safer and healthier life for people everywhere.

dupont.com

in.dupont.com



The miracles of science™

© 2007 DuPont. All rights reserved. The DuPont Oval Logo, DuPont™, The miracles of science™ and all brand names with™ and® are registered trademarks or trademarks of DuPont or its affiliates.

Which DuPont product represents the science of fresh? Email your answer to info.india@ind.dupont.com & win a prize!

*Terms & conditions apply